Iteration H1: Sending Confirmation Emails

Sending email in Rails has three basic parts: configuring how email is to be sent, determining when to send the email, and specifying what you want to say. We'll cover each of these three in turn.

Configuring Email

Email configuration is part of a Rails application's environment and involves a `Rails.application.configure` block. If you want to use the same configuration for development, testing, and production, add the configuration to `environment.rb` in the `config` directory; otherwise, add different configurations to the appropriate files in the `config/environments` directory.

Inside the block, you need to have one or more statements. You first have to decide how you want mail delivered:

```
config.action_mailer.delivery_method = :smtp
```

Alternatives to `:smtp` include `:sendmail` and `:test`.

The `:smtp` and `:sendmail` options are used when you want Action Mailer to attempt to deliver email. You'll clearly want to use one of these methods in production.

The `:test` setting is great for unit and functional testing, which we'll make use of in *Testing Email*. Email won't be delivered; instead, it'll be appended to an array (accessible via the `ActionMailer::Base.deliveries` attribute). This is the default delivery method in the test environment. Interestingly, though, the default in development mode is `:smtp`. If you want Rails to deliver email during the development of your application, this is good. If you'd rather disable email delivery in development mode, edit the `development.rb` file in the `config/environments` directory and add the following lines:

```
Rails.application.configure do
  config.action_mailer.delivery_method = :test
end
```